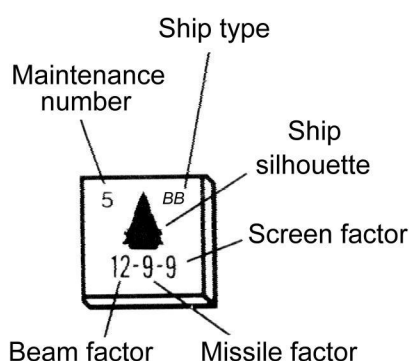
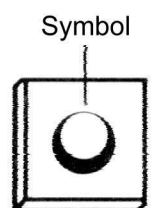


IMPERIUM

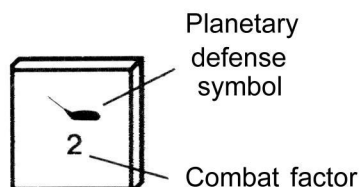
Imperium is a science-fiction game about interstellar war. Several hundred years from now, Terra reaches the stars, only to find that they are already owned by a vast, sprawling interstellar empire: the Ziru Sirka (the Grand Empire of Stars or Imperium). The heavy hand of the Imperium and the expansionism of Earth lead naturally and inexorably to interstellar war. Imperium is a boardgame of that conflict.



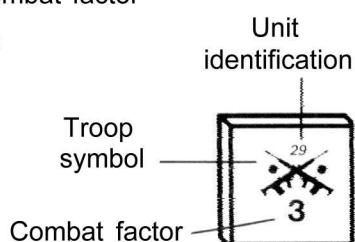
Ship Counter



Marker



Planetary Defense Marker



Troop Counter

A single game is one war. One player is Terra, and the other is the Imperium. Each has the opportunity to move forces to strategic positions, to attack the enemy, and to invade enemy-held locations. Economics (dependent on the territory a player controls) plays an important role in the production of new and replacement combat forces. Strategy is

important in determining when and where to attack the enemy; tactics are important in resolving individual battles. Victory for either side depends on the state of the Imperial player's reputation, evaluated in glory points.

At the end of each war, the peace treaty determines what forces will remain on the map and where they will be. When the next war begins (there is always a next war), these positions and forces are the starting point for hostilities.

A campaign consists of several wars and ends only with the conquest by one side of the other side's capital. While a war may be fought in an evening, a campaign is fought over the course of several weeks.

GAME COMPONENTS

Imperium includes as components a map board, two sheets of counters, a rule booklet, a set of charts, and two dice. The box serves to store components between games.

Counters: Each of the two players receives a set of counters, which represents such items as starships, troops, planetary defences, and possession markers. Counters are colour-coded: Imperial forces are red and black; Terran forces are blue and green.

Map: The map is the playing surface for Imperium; it is a graphic display of stars and planetary surfaces. At one edge appears a descriptive map legend.

Centred on the map is a two-dimensional display showing the stellar neighbourhood of Sol at a scale of one-half parsec (about 1.67 light-years) per hex and extending to a radius of about six parsecs. Map symbols represent stars, planetary surfaces and jump routes. The following terms are used in the rules to refer to the map and to map locations.

Most hexagons (called hexes) on the map are black and blank. These are *interstellar space hexes*. The presence of a *jump route line* or of lettering has no effect on an otherwise blank hex.

A *stellar hex* is any map hexagon, which has one star in it; a hex with two stars in it is a binary stellar hex. Most stellar and *binary stellar hexes* are the endpoints of *jump routes*.

In general, the term stellar hex includes binary stellar hex unless a point of differentiation is being made.

Those stars that have planets are marked with an adjacent planetary surface box, representing the combined surfaces of the planets in the system for purposes of manoeuvre, development, and control. Each planetary surface box is printed in a hex adjacent to the star, but represents a location within the stellar hex. The planetary surface box should not be confused with the interstellar space hex in which it is printed.

Binary stellar hexes, in some cases, have two planetary surface boxes—one for each star with planets. Stars such as white dwarf companions (like Sirius) do not have planetary surface boxes.

Planetary surface boxes are further classified (colour-coded) by the quality of the planets represented. Naturally habitable worlds are classed as primary and coded white; all others are classed as secondary and coded red.

In the course of the game, world markers may only be placed in primary planetary surface boxes; outpost markers may be placed in any box.

A stellar hex together with its adjacent planetary surface box or boxes is considered to be a system. This term is used to designate possible locations for starships or other forces.

For example, a starship in a system could be in the stellar hex (in space) or in a planetary surface box (on the ground).

The quality of the Nusku/Dushaam system is dependent upon the planetary surface box in use; if one player controls both boxes, he has a choice as to which box (and thus system type) controls a situation.

Resource and Turn Tracks: Each player uses markers to record their Resource Units (RU's) and Player Turn.

The Terran turn marker starts just below the "1" box on the Turn Track and moves up one box at the start of each Terran Player Turn. The Imperial turn marker starts just above the "10" box on the Turn Track and moves down one box at the start of each Imperial Player Turn.

GAME TURN SEQUENCE OF PLAY

Terran Player Turn

1. Terran Maintenance and Production Phase.
 - a) Senate Intervention Table.
 - b) Income Computation.
 - c) Maintenance.
 - d) Research and Development.
 - e) Production.
 - f) New Production Received.
2. Terran First Movement Phase.
3. Terran First Combat Phase.
 - a) Refuelling Subphase.
 - b) Space Combat Subphase.
 - c) Surface/Space Interaction Subphase.
 - d) Surface Combat Subphase.
4. Imperial Reaction Movement Phase.
5. Imperial Reaction Combat Phase.
6. Terran Second Movement Phase.
7. Terran Second Combat Phase.

Imperial Player Turn

1. Imperial Maintenance and Production Phase.
 - a) Imperial Intervention Table.
 - b) Appeals to the Emperor.
 - c) Income Computation.
 - d) Maintenance.
 - e) Production.
 - f) New Production Received.
2. Imperial First Movement Phase.
3. Imperial First Combat Phase.
 - a) Refuelling Subphase.
 - b) Space Combat Subphase.
 - c) Surface/Space Interaction Subphase.
 - d) Surface Combat Subphase.
4. Terran Reaction Movement Phase.
5. Terran Reaction Combat Phase.
6. Imperial Second Movement Phase.
7. Imperial Second Combat Phase.

A player (in his player turn) is allowed two opportunities for movement (the First and Second Movement Phases) and combat (the First and Second Combat Phases). Between these two opportunities, the enemy player is allowed a limited opportunity to move (the Reaction Movement Phase) and attack (the Reaction Combat Phase).

SEQUENCE OF PLAY

Imperium is played in turns: called *game turns* to distinguish them from player turns. A game turn is one complete cycle of two player turns (one for each of the two players).

Each game turn is divided into phases and subphases in order to carefully state what moves and what decisions can be made at what times. Game activity that is not allowed by the sequence of play, or activity which is performed out of sequence, is prohibited.

The Phasing Player: The player who is currently moving or performing some activity is defined as the phasing player. Conversely, the non-phasing player is the phasing player's opponent.

For example, in the Terran First Movement Phase, the phasing player is the Terran, and the non-phasing player is the Imperial. In the Imperial Reaction Combat Phase, the phasing player is the Imperial, and the non-phasing player is the Terran.

In the first game, the Terran player moves first. The sequence of play shows the Terran player turn occurring first. In later games, the loser of the previous game moves first. In those cases, reverse the order of the player turns.

Two player turns make a game turn.

MOVEMENT

Starships may move on the map from stellar hex to stellar hex by using hyperspace jumps to move along jump routes. Fighters and monitors (because they lack jump drives) may not make hyperspace jumps. Troops, outposts, planetary defence markers and fighters may be carried from location to location in transport ships. World markers, monitors and all other ships except fighters may not be transported.

Hyperspace Jump: Hyperspace jump involves movement directly between stellar hexes at faster than light speeds. Jumps are possible only along the routes printed on the map; each jump route is a green line connecting two stellar hexes.

In game terms, each hyperspace jump is expressed as movement from one stellar hex to another stellar hex along a jump route. The ship does not actually enter the intervening

hexes and cannot be affected by forces in those hexes.

Jumps may be made in the player's First and Second Movement Phases, and in the player's Reaction Movement Phase.

A jump must be from a stellar hex to a stellar hex. It may not begin or end on a portion of a jump route lying between the ends.

Provided that it can refuel before each jump, each of a player's ships is allowed an unlimited number of hyperspace jumps during each Movement Phase.

Ships may end their movement at any time, or they may elect not to move and, therefore, remain in their present hexes.

Reaction Movement: During the Reaction Movement Phase, the phasing player may designate any one stack of ships (including any cargo which is already embarked) as his reaction force. This stack must be in a single hex or in a single planetary surface box. This force may make up to three jumps if Imperial, or two jumps if Terran (subject to all restrictions which apply to normal jumps). Ships in the reaction force need not all jump to the same destination.

Refuelling: All ships use hydrogen as fuel. This fuel can only be obtained in any stellar hex. However, ships wanting to refuel quickly during the Movement Phase and keep moving can only do so from Outposts, Worlds or stationary tankers. Any ship arriving in a stellar hex containing a friendly Outpost marker, a friendly World marker or a stationary, friendly tanker may immediately refuel and continue moving. Otherwise, the ship must wait until the start of the Combat Phase to refuel.

A tanker only counts as a source of fuel in a stellar hex if it ends its Movement Phase in that hex.

Enemy forces in a stellar hex prohibit ships from refuelling in that hex during a Movement or Reaction Movement Phase. The moving ships must then stop and attack the enemy ship or ships in the following Combat Phase. Those ships, which stop to do battle, must wait to continue movement until the following Movement Phase. Transport, tanker, and mothership counters have no attack factors and are incapable of combat. Ships jumping to a hex containing only these types of ships may ignore them and continue to move.

Thus, each of the players' ships may continue making hyperspace jumps until a hex lacking a fuel source or containing one or more enemy starships with attack factors is entered.

Scouts are capable of refuelling in a stellar hex regardless of the presence of a friendly fuel source. Only the presence of enemy ships prevents a Scout from refuelling in the Movement Phase.

TRANSPORTATION

Non-ships (troops, unplaced outposts, and planetary defence markers) and fighters may be transported through space by some ships.

One counter (representing the cargo) may be carried by a transport. The cargo should be placed under the transport ship counter to indicate that it is being transported.

Capital ships (B, B1, B2, and BB) may carry one fighter or jump troop counter, but no other type of cargo. Mothership counters may each carry three jump troops or fighters, but no other type of cargo.

Ships may always embark or disembark a cargo in a friendly planetary surface box (in a system which contains a friendly world or outpost marker): A single transporting ship may not carry more than one distinct cargo (embarking and disembarking the counters once) in a single Movement Phase.

If a ship is delivering a cargo in a system that is non-friendly (but which is not necessarily an enemy system), then movement from space to the planetary surface box must take place during the Surface/ Space Interaction Subphase of the Combat Phase.

In the Reaction Phase, starships transporting cargoes may embark or disembark cargo, but not both. Such transports would necessarily be part of the reaction force.

Cargoes may not be transferred between ships in space. A mothership or capital ship may both launch and retrieve fighters while in space, but transports are not allowed to do so.

When a ship is destroyed in combat, its cargo is also destroyed.

COMBAT

Each Combat Phase consists of three subphases, allowing space combat, planetary bombardment and planetary defence fire, and surface combat.

Space Combat

Space combat is a series of rounds. Each is an exchange of fire between enemy ships in the same hex and takes place during the Space Combat Subphase. Space combat usually occurs in stellar hexes, but may occur in any hex. Each player prepares for space combat by laying out his ships (all ships, including transports with cargoes) in a blank area of the map or table. If a mothership is present, it may launch or take on fighters at this time, and at the beginning of each combat round.

The phasing player is the attacker; his opponent is the defender. Each combat round consists of range determination, ship allocation, and combat resolution.

Range Determination: Space combat occurs at one of two ranges. *Long range* allows the use of only missiles in the attack; *short range* allows the use of missiles (but at reduced factor) or beams. *Range for the first combat round is automatically long.*

To determine the range in each subsequent combat round, each player rolls one die. The player with the smaller force (the fewer ship counters present, not counting fighters) may add one to his die roll. The player achieving the higher die roll has the option of changing range. Such a change may be from long to short, or from short to long. If the range determination die roll comparison is a tie, range automatically remains the same in the current round, and changes to the other range in the following combat round. No range determination is then necessary in that second round. All starships in a hex are at the same range, and all starships change range together. Starships belonging to one player may not occupy different ranges.

Any jump-capable ship may be selected to break off the engagement in any combat round provided a suitable exit route exists. The owning player may declare that the ship is breaking off as a combat option after ship allocation is complete. The ship remains in combat for the current combat round but may not fire. At the end of the combat round, if it survives and a suitable destination exists, it may jump out of the system.

Ship Allocation: After range is determined, players allocate their ships to specific attacks.

The defender moves one of his starships forward, and the attacker allocates one of his ships against that ship. The defender then moves another starship forward to be matched by another attacking ship. This procedure continues until all defending starships have been moved forward, or until there are no more attacking starships. Extra ships at this point (unmatched defending ships or extra attacking ships) may be allocated to any enemy ships, doubling or tripling up for maximum effect (there is no limit to the number of extra ships which may be allocated against an enemy ship). Extra ships may alternatively elect to sit out the combat round, being screened from fire by the ships engaged in combat. After specific ships have been allocated, their tactics may be declared. The attacker first declares his combat options (such as break-off, short-range missile fire, suicide attacks, high-intensity fire, etc.). The defender declares any options he may wish and notes any defensive fire that has become available to him. The attacker then notes any defensive fire that has become available to him by reason of the defender's combat options (the various options are detailed in later sections of this rule). Combat is then resolved.

Combat Resolution: During the combat round, each ship fires at an enemy ship matched against it. Each starship may fire once per combat round using either beam or missile fire. If more than one enemy ship is matched against a ship it may choose which enemy ship it fires on.

To fire at an enemy ship at long range, a player notes the missile factor of his ship and the screen factor of the target. The Missile Combat Results Table is then consulted. The proper missile factor row and screen factor - column are located; at the intersection of the row and column is the hit number required for the destruction of the target. The attacker then rolls one die and compares that result with the hit number; if the result is equal to or greater than the hit number the target is destroyed and removed from play. If the result is less than the hit number, the attack has no effect. At long range, an attacking ship may elect to use high-intensity fire (detailed below), and add +1 to his die roll.

To fire at an enemy ship at short range, the procedure is much the same, but more options are available, and beam factors are the primary weapons used. The attacking beam factor and the target's screen factor are used to determine the required hit number (and the Beam Combat Results Table is consulted). One die is rolled and the effect noted. At short range, a ship may elect to make a suicide attack (described below), gaining a +1 die roll modification by first undergoing enemy defensive fire. Missiles may be fired at short range with a die roll modification of -1 if the ship does not fire beams and survives beam fire in the round. Space combat is normally considered to be simultaneous within a combat round. All possible attacks are made and destroyed starships are allowed to fire before being removed from play (except for ships using short-range missile fire and the victims of defensive fire). Both players may attack within the round using all available starships. All space combat is resolved before play proceeds to the next subphase (the Planetary Surface/Space Interaction Subphase).

Combat Options

Combat options are described below.

Break-Off: Individually, after ship allocation, any starship that is capable of making a hyperspace jump may indicate that it is breaking off. It must remain in combat for the current combat round but may not fire. At the end of the round, if it survives, it may then jump out of the hex. A priority for this jump exists: If possible, the break-off jump must be to a friendly system (one jump away) with no enemy ships present. Failing that, the break-off jump must be to an empty system (one jump away). If either of these two options is not available, breaking off cannot occur.

Ships that cannot perform hyperspace jumps (monitors, fighters, reaction forces which have already jumped as many times as they are allowed, and disrupted starships unable to make the required die roll) may not break-off.

High-Intensity Missile Fire: A starship may expend its entire supply of missiles in a single attack in an attempt to overwhelm its target with a high intensity of fire. The ship then adds one to its die roll before comparing it to the re-

quired hit number. The ship has then exhausted its missile supply, and its missile factor is reduced to zero for the remainder of the current Combat Phase.

Short-Range Missile Fire: Starships may fire missiles at short range (disregarding the fact that the superiority of beams at short range drastically reduces the effectiveness of missiles). Missile fire at short range is made with a die roll modifier of -1. The firing ship may not attack until all beam fire (except suicide attacks) has been resolved. Ships destroyed by beam fire may not then fire missiles at short range. A ship at short range may elect to fire missiles and also to make a high-intensity attack.

Suicide Attacks: A ship with a beam factor may make a suicide attack if at short range provided it first undergoes defensive fire from its target. The attacker declares suicide attacks first, and those ships making suicide attacks may not themselves be attacked in this manner.

The target of a suicide attack is entitled to defensive fire: The target fires on the attacker using beams or missiles, and if it destroys that ship, the suicide attacker is not allowed to fire at all during the combat round and is removed from play immediately. If the suicide attacker survives the defensive fire, it then attacks in the normal manner, but may add one to its die roll before comparing it to the required hit number.

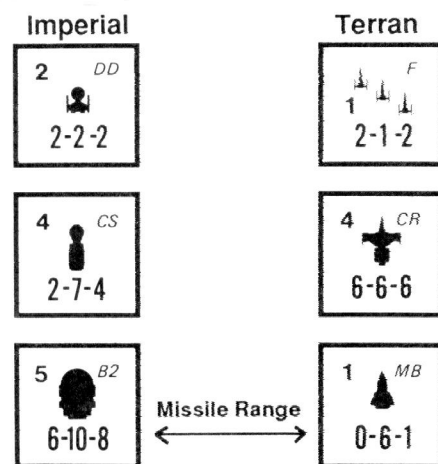
Normally, a ship may only fire once in the firing round. However, if more than one suicide attack occurs against a single ship, that ship may make defensive firing attempts once against each of the attacking ships. A ship that has used defensive fire has used its ability to fire and may not fire normally in the same combat round.

Disrupted Starships: Ships may become disrupted as a result of faulty maintenance. Disrupted starships subtract one from the die roll when attacking. When a disrupted starship is attacked, the attacking vessel may add one to its die roll. Disrupted starships may make suicide attacks, but may not conduct high-intensity fire.

Terminating Combat: Space combat ends when all ships from one side have either broken-off from the engagement or been destroyed. If only one player's ships remain in the hex that player's forces have won, and the victor now controls the hex.

General Notes: No ship may fire more than once per combat round (except when allowed to by defensive fire). Several ships may not combine their fire against a single target; targets each defend individually.

Example:



Space Combat

The ships have been paired off at missile range. DD attacks F at missile 2 vs. screen 2. It rolls 6 and destroys the F. F counterattacks at missile 1 vs. screen 2, rolls a 4, and has no effect.

CS attacks CR at missile 7 vs. screen 6. CR declares high-intensity missile fire. CS rolls a 6 and destroys the CR. CR fires missile 6 vs. screen 4 and rolls a 4 (+1), destroying the CS.

B2 fires against MB with missile 10 vs. screen 1. MB declares high-intensity missile fire. B2 rolls a 3 and destroys the MB. MB counterattacks the B2 with missile 6 vs. screen 8 and rolls a 6 (+1), destroying the B2. The Imperial DD is the only ship left. The Imperium wins the battle.

Planetary Surface/Space Interaction

After space combat, ships that are in possession of a system hex may interact with the associated planetary surface box. If the planetary surface box is already friendly,

landings may be made. If the box is not friendly (not necessarily enemy), bombardment may occur, planetary defence firing attempts may be made, and landings may then be performed.

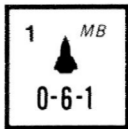
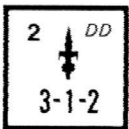
Planetary Bombardment: Ships may elect to bombard enemy forces in a planetary surface box by allocating missile factors. Each enemy counter in the box is a target. No ship may bombard more than once; however, several ships may bombard the same target. Each attacking ship chooses a single target and cross-references its missile factor against a die roll on the Planetary Bombardment Table. If the target is a planetary defence marker or jump troop +1 is added to the die roll. If the target is a world marker +2 is added to the die roll. Three results are possible on the Planetary Bombardment Table: no effect, target neutralized and target destroyed. A neutralized target is inverted, and remains so until the end of the player turn; it may not attack (either with planetary defence fire or against troops) but defends normally.

Planetary Defence Fire: World, outpost, and planetary defence markers may fire at ships that have conducted bombardment and ships wishing to land on the planetary surface box. Each marker (of the three noted above) may fire at each incoming ship. For example, if a planetary surface box contains a world marker and a planetary defence marker, each would fire at each enemy starship that is vulnerable. Each firing marker fires once at each vulnerable ship by rolling one die and consulting the Planetary Defence Fire Table. If the target starship has a screen factor of 3 or greater, add +1 to the die roll before consulting the table. If the target starship has a screen factor of 7 or greater, add +2 to the die roll before consulting the table (thus, starships with a higher defence factor are less vulnerable to planetary defence fire). The die roll is indexed to the table and the column corresponding to the marker firing.

Two results are possible on the table: no effect and target destroyed. A destroyed target is immediately removed from play. The destruction of a ship also destroys any cargo it is carrying.

Jump troops are capable of landing directly from space without being transported down by a ship. Such units are ejected in space by a mothership or capital ship, and each is then subject to planetary defence fire individually (the ship is not subject to firing attempts). Jump troops are treated (for the purposes of planetary defence fire) as having a screen factor of 7 and thus get the +2 die roll modification when landing. Note that planetary bombardment can destroy or neutralize planetary defence markers before they are able to fire, thus allowing undisturbed landings by starships or troops.

Example:

Terran			
Imperial			(Outpost)

MB chooses to bombard Imperial Troop 741 with 6 missile factors. He rolls a 1, and the troop is neutralized. B chooses to bombard the Imperial outpost marker with 9 missile factors. He rolls a 5, and there is no effect. The DD cannot harm either target and so chooses not to bombard.

The Imperial outpost fires once at each ship, and rolls a 4 against the B (no effect), and a 1 against the MB (destroyed). The DD did not bombard, so it may not be targeted by planetary defence fire.

Surface Combat

Surface combat consists of a single combat round, being an exchange of fire between enemy forces in the same planetary surface box and occurring during the Surface Combat Subphase. Surface combat must occur in a planetary surface box.

The phasing player is the attacker; his opponent is the defender.

Preparation: Each player temporarily removes his non-starship counters from the

specific planetary surface box to some clear area of the map or table. As was done in space combat, the defender moves forward one troop counter (regular or jump troop): The attacker responds by matching this unit with one of his troop counters. This Surface Combat procedure continues until either the defender or the attacker has no more troop counters available. Either player in this procedure may use neutralized troops; they may be attacked, but may not themselves attack. Starships never participate in surface combat; if all friendly forces are destroyed, any accompanying starships (and unplaced cargoes) are eliminated.

If the attacker has fewer troops than the defender the defender may commit his excess troops against attacking troop counters, doubling or tripling up (or more) for maximum effect. If the defender has fewer troops than the attacker, the defender must now move forward non-troop counters (planetary defence markers, world or outpost markers), each to be matched by an attacking troop counter.

All defending counters not involved in this preparation are now screened, and do not participate in surface combat at any time during this subphase. Set them aside.

Thus, a planetary surface box cannot be conquered in one subphase if the number of attacking troops is less than the number of defending counters.

Combat: Once units have been allocated (roughly in pairs), the attacking and defending counters are each allowed one attack (but neutralized counters may not attack - they may only defend). Note that only troop counters may initiate attacks, but that any non-starship counter may counterattack troop counters that are attacking it.

Troop and planetary defence markers are each printed with the combat factor with which they attack and defend.

Outpost markers have a combat factor of 1. World markers have a combat factor of 3; except for the home world of Sol and the provincial capital of Gashidda: each of which has a combat factor of 5.

Combat is resolved using the Surface Combat Results Table. Each troop counter may fire at one of the counters matched against it. To fire at an enemy counter, a player

notes the attack factor of his counter and the defence factor of the target. The Surface Combat Results Table is then consulted. The proper attack factor row and defence factor column are located; at the intersection of the row and column is the hit number required for the destruction of the target. The attacker then rolls one die and compares that result with the hit number. If the result is equal to or greater than the hit number the target is destroyed and removed from play. If the result is less than the hit number, the attack has no effect. When a world marker receives a result of destroyed, it is instead neutralized and remains so until the end of the player turn. A world can never be destroyed as a result of combat.

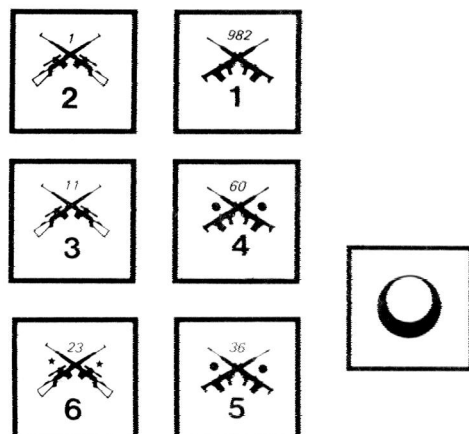
Each counter may fire once in a combat round unless destroyed by 'first fire'.

First Fire: In the first Surface Combat sub-phase after they land from space, jump troops get a 'first fire' advantage versus any other counters. The jump troop counter resolves its attack completely before its target gets a chance to fire. If the target is destroyed, it does not get a counter-attack.

However, under all other circumstances, regular troop counters have 'first fire' advantage versus any counters except other regulars.

Triggering Combat: Surface combat is triggered when enemy non-starship counters are present in the same planetary surface box. Since there is only one round of surface combat per Combat Phase, enemy counters may continue to share a surface box for more than one Turn. For either side, if all friendly forces have been destroyed, any accompanying starships (and unplaced cargoes) are eliminated.

Example:



Troop units have been paired off, and the Imperial outpost marker is screened. It cannot be attacked this Round. Troops are identified by their factors.

Troop 2 attacks Troop 1, rolls a 4 and destroys it. Troop 1 counterattacks, rolls a 4, and destroys Troop 2.

Troop 3 attacks Jump Troop 4 using first fire, rolls a 6, and destroys it. Troop 4 cannot counter-attack.

Jump Troop 6 attacks Jump Troop 5 using first fire, rolls a 5, and destroys it. Jump Troop 5 cannot counterattack.

Since all surviving counters have fired, surface combat is ended.

Reaction Fire

Certain restrictions apply to the Reaction Combat Phase. Only those counters involved in Reaction Movement (the single stack allowed to move during the phase) may participate in the Reaction Combat Phase. If those counters enter a situation where other friendly forces are also present, they may join the attack. Enemy forces present in such locations may defend normally by taking part in the action.

STARSHIPS

Each starship counter represents a squadron of individual ships. Each counter is marked with beam, missile, and screen factors, and a maintenance number, and an abbreviation for ship type. Counters also carry a ship silhouette that is used for recognition.

Support Ships

Support ships provide basic services to the fleet, although they are not effective fighting ships.

Transports (TR) are cargo-carrying ships capable of moving unplaced outposts, planetary defence markers, troops, and fighter counters from place to place. One transport carries one counter as a cargo. Transports are not capable of launching or retrieving fighters in space; or of ejecting jump troops for planetary assaults.

Production Cost: 1RU.

Tankers (AO) are mobile stations capable of manufacturing fuel. A tanker is required to

finish in the same stellar hex for which it is providing a fuel source if it supplies fuel to other ships.

Production Cost: 2 RU.

Small Combatants

Small combatants are lightly armed and armoured ships intended for escort or exploration duty.

Scouts (SC) are small, lightly armed ships originally designed for exploration and courier duties. Scouts may refuel during the Movement Phase in stellar hexes that do not contain a friendly fuel source.

Production Cost: 2 RU.

Destroyers (DD) are small fleet units designed for escort duty and limited independent operations.

Production Cost: 3 RU.

Cruisers

Cruisers form the major heavy fleet elements of any force, due to their relatively low maintenance cost and high firepower. Cruisers undergoing civilised maintenance pay RU's equal to their maintenance number minus one.

Light cruisers (CL) are the smallest of the cruiser-type ships.

Production Cost: 5 RU.

Strike cruisers (CS) are characterized by high missile factors, lending themselves to a variety of missions (especially planetary bombardment).

Production Cost: 8 RU.

Heavy cruisers (CR), the standard cruiser, exhibit a homogeneous beam-missile-screen armament.

Production Cost: 10 RU.

Attack cruisers (CA) are uniquely Imperial, featuring an increased beam factor.

Production Cost: 12 RU.

Capital Ships

The general class of capital ship includes dreadnoughts, improved dreadnoughts, and battleships. Capital ships are each capable of carrying one fighter or jump troop counter as

cargo. A capital ship may launch and retrieve one fighter every space combat round. A capital ship is capable of ejecting jump troops so that they may land on a planet directly from space. Capital ships are better equipped to defend against planetary defence fire because each has a screen factor of 7 or greater. All capital ships require two turns for construction.

Dreadnoughts (Terran abbreviation B; Imperial abbreviation: B1) are heavily armed and armoured starships intended as the mainstay of the fleet. The maintenance cost for such vessels greatly hinders their usefulness.

Production Cost: 16 RU.

Improved dreadnoughts: (B2) are evolutionary Imperial developments of the dreadnought.

Production Cost: 20 RU.

Battleships (BB) are the ultimate in capital ships with the highest available firepower and armour

Production Cost: 24 RU.

Special Ships

Special ship types perform a variety of missions.

Missile boats (MB) are a strictly Terran development and represent the installation of missile launching equipment in small, easily produced hulls. This development is a reaction to the high Imperial missile factors in common use. Missile boats may not perform Frontier Maintenance; unless able to perform Civilised Maintenance they are automatically disrupted.

Production Cost: 3 RU.

Fighters (F) are small craft designed for tactical combat. They are incapable of hyperspace jumps, but may be carried as cargoes. Fighters require a base before they may operate. A base may be a friendly world or outpost, or it may be a mothership, or a capital ship (B, B1, B2, or BB). Fighters do not count towards the number of starships present for the purposes of range determination in space combat.

Production Cost: 2 RU.

Motherships (MS) are carriers capable of transporting, launching and retrieving fighters

for combat and jump troops for planetary assault. A Mothership can carry up to three fighters or jump troops. Disruption of a mothership disrupts its fighters and jump troops if they are aboard. A Mothership is capable of ejecting jump troops so that they may land on a planet directly from space. A mothership may launch and retrieve up to three fighters every space combat round. Fighters and jump troops are not included in the production of a mothership.

Production Cost: 4 RU.

Monitors (M) are heavily armed ships incapable of performing the hyperspace jump; they may only move using sub-light drive. Monitors are pre-dreadnought in design, with Imperial models concentrating on missiles and Terran models concentrating on beams.

Production Cost: 8 RU.

Troops

The two troop types are jump troops and regular troops. Troops are not subject to maintenance costs. Troops may operate only in planetary surface boxes and perform no function while in space as cargo.

Regular troops represent the ordinary military manpower of Terra and the Imperium. Because they include the firepower of heavy artillery, regular troop counters get a 'first fire' advantage in surface combat except against jump troops landing from space.

Production Cost: 2 RU.

Jump troops are the elite of the armed forces of both sides. Each counter represents a highly trained and specially equipped division characterized by high combat factors and jump capability. In the first Surface Combat Round after they land from space, jump troop counters get a 'first fire' advantage in surface combat.

Production Cost: 3 RU.

Troop units may be raised by paying the required RUs and placing the counter on the Turn Record Chart to appear in the next friendly player turn. Newly produced troops have low combat factors, which can be increased through training and combat. All new troops produced by the Imperial player must have a combat factor of 1 if regular or 3 if

jump. All new troops produced by the Terran player must have a combat factor of 2 if regular or 4 if jump. If the new counter is not available, the troop counter may not be produced. Troop combat factors may be increased in two ways:

- a) In the Maintenance subphase the owning player may pay 1 RU to replace an existing troop counter (even if still on the Turn Record Chart, but not if on an unconnected outpost) with one that has a combat factor +1 higher (e.g. replace a 2 troop with a 3 troop).
- b) Any troop counter that survives surface combat with enemy non-starship counters is replaced by a troop with a combat factor +1 higher.

However, if the new counter is not available, the troop counter may not be promoted.

Also, until the "Advanced Troops" technology is acquired, the Terran player may not increase Jump Troops above a combat factor of 5 or Regular Troops above a combat factor of 3.

Markers

Markers include world, outpost, and planetary defence.

World markers represent civilization, population, and industrial centres in primary systems. World markers may not be manufactured, nor eliminated as a result of combat; a combat result of "destroyed" merely neutralises them until the end of the player turn. In order for the world marker to remain neutralised the attacking player must maintain troops with a total combat factor at least equal to the world marker's defence factor in the planetary surface box. An enemy world marker can be kept permanently neutralised by placing an outpost marker in the planetary surface box with it.

Outposts represent the (sometimes extensive) establishments to exploit and hold secondary systems. Outposts may be manufactured and held in reserve until needed; at such time, each must be transported to the correct planetary surface box. An outpost does not become operational until all enemy forces in the planetary surface box are eliminated. Only one operational outpost may be in a

planetary surface box; an outpost may be placed in a planetary surface box with a neutralized enemy world (if that world marker is the only enemy force in the box) and made operational. In such case, the outpost denotes ownership and keeps the enemy world marker permanently neutralized.

Production Cost: 4 RU.

Planetary defence markers represent extensive batteries of missile and beam installations as well as supporting fire control positions. Planetary defences provide anti-starship fire and surface strongpoints. Planetary defence markers are manufactured and must be transported into place. Each becomes operational at the end of the player turn in which it is placed. Only one planetary defence marker may be operational in any one surface box.

Production Cost: 8 RU.

Bookkeeping markers are included for the players' convenience.

Each player receives a blank counter to mark the turn on the Turn Record Chart. The Terran one starts each war just below the "1" box; the Imperial one starts just above the "10" box. At the start of each Terran player turn the Terran marker is moved up one box. At the start of each Imperial turn the Imperial marker is moved down one box. *Note that the turn markers move towards one another from opposite ends of the Turn Record Chart.*

The Imperial player places his glory marker on the "5" of the Turn Record Chart, moving the marker to indicate changes in the glory level. The war/peace marker is used on the War/Peace Chart. Each player also has markers printed with 0 and 00. Using the 0 marker for ones and the 00 marker for tens, resource units available to each side can be indicated to a maximum of 99 RU.

ECONOMICS

Each player counts his income in resource units (RU). These RU are used to pay maintenance costs and for the production of new forces. Each player computes his income during his Maintenance and Production Phase and notes the new balance on the Resource Unit Chart. Although the chart only allows tracking up to 99 units, you may have more.

Imperial Income: Imperial income is based on the Imperial budget (10 RU per turn at the start of the campaign), plus 3 RU from each connected world and 1 RU from each unconnected world (nothing is received for outposts). In addition, the Imperial player may receive income as a result of Imperial intervention or as a response to an appeal to the emperor.

Terran Income: Terran income is based on worlds under Terran control: connected worlds (8 RU), unconnected worlds (6 RU), and connected outposts (1 RU). Unconnected outposts produce no RU.

Income Terms: The term *world* refers to a world marker of the correct player placed in a primary planetary surface box. An *outpost* refers to an outpost marker of the correct player placed in any planetary surface box.

A world is *connected* if a path may be traced from it to Sol (for the Terran) or to Gashidda (for the Imperial) via any number of continuous jump routes. An outpost is *connected* if a path may be traced from it to any friendly world via any number of continuous jump routes. System hexes along the connection path must be free of enemy starships other than tankers or transports. Several unconnected worlds may each have outposts connected to them, with each outpost creating income. In order for a path to be traced through an empty system hex (no friendly world or outpost present), a friendly tanker must be present at the time the path is traced.

Maintenance: Each ship in the game has a maintenance number which expresses the unit's relative maintenance burden. This number is used in several operations, including determining maintenance cost for civilized maintenance, making hyperspace jumps while disrupted, and performing frontier maintenance. Maintenance is required for all of the phasing player's ships each player turn. Maintenance is of two types:

Civilized maintenance applies to all starships in a primary system marked with a friendly world marker in the planetary surface box. The owning player must expend RUs equal to the maintenance number for each starship to

perform maintenance. If he chooses not to, then the ship becomes disrupted. Ships in location mandating civilized maintenance must perform it by payments of RU (rather than the frontier maintenance procedure described below). Maintenance and payment of necessary costs occurs before newly produced units appear and new production is initiated. Maintenance is not required for new units on the turn in which they appear.

Frontier maintenance applies to all other situations, including starships in interstellar space hexes, in stellar hexes with friendly outposts, and in stellar hexes with enemy worlds. The owning player must roll one die for each starship: If the result is equal to or greater than the ship's maintenance number, maintenance has been successfully performed. If the system does not contain a friendly outpost, the player must decrease the die roll result by one before comparing it with the ship's maintenance number. Failure to make the throw indicates that the starship is disrupted. Ships not in a location mandating civilized maintenance must undergo frontier maintenance. A player with ships in the Nusku/Dushaam system who controls both the primary and secondary planetary surface boxes may select the form of maintenance to be performed on his ships. Disruption is indicated by inverting the affected starship counter.

Exceptions: Terran Missile boats cannot perform Frontier Maintenance. If unable (or unwilling) to perform civilised maintenance, they are automatically disrupted.

Effects of Disruption: Starships that have become disrupted are hindered in their ability to conduct hyperspace jumps and to conduct combat. A disrupted starship must successfully roll its maintenance number or greater on one die before each hyperspace jump it attempts (from a system to a system). Failure to achieve the required die roll means that it may move no farther in the player turn. A disrupted starship in combat must subtract one from its attack die roll before consulting the Beam Combat Results or Missile Combat Results Table. Any ship attacking a disrupted starship may add one to its attacking die roll before consulting these tables. When planetary defences

(worlds, outposts, planetary defence markers) fire on a disrupted starship, each may subtract one from the die roll before consulting the Planetary Defence Fire Table. Disrupted ships otherwise capable of carrying cargos remain capable of carrying cargos. Disrupted motherships may continue to carry, launch, and retrieve fighters.

Recovering from Disruption: A ship that has become disrupted remains disrupted until recovery can be accomplished. Recovery takes place during the Maintenance subphase.

- In a primary system with a friendly world marker present, the disrupted ship must pay its maintenance number plus one in RU, and becomes undisrupted immediately.
- In any situation calling for frontier maintenance, the disrupted ship must roll one die. If this result exceeds the ship's maintenance number, the ship becomes undisrupted immediately.

Ships may move (subject to restrictions on movement) to a location favourable to recovery.

Production: During the Production subphase the phasing player expends resource units to initiate production of forces. The costs associated with forces are shown on the Production Cost Table. As ships and forces are purchased, the counters for each are selected from the counter mix and placed on the Turn Record Chart to appear on the next game turn. Capital ships (types B, B1, B2, and BB) must be placed so as to appear in two turns. There is no limit to the number of ships or other forces which may be produced in a turn, provided the player has available sufficient resource units to pay for them and the counters are available. In the New Production Received subphase, he then removes newly produced forces for this turn from the Turn Record Chart and brings them into play. Newly produced forces may appear at any friendly world or at any connected outpost. Starships may be placed anywhere in the system (in space or in the planetary surface box); all other forces must appear in the planetary surface box. Outposts and planetary defence markers appear in an

unplaced state and must be moved to their ultimate location during the movement phases.

Imperial Production Restrictions: As a matter of policy the Imperium controls the production of starships, restricting the types that may be locally produced. As a result, the Imperium prohibits (at least initially) the production of major starships (specifically types CR, CA, B1, B2, and BB). They may appear only as a result of Imperial intervention or after receiving permission from the emperor to build such ships locally. All other ship types may be built without restriction.

Imperial Replacements: The Imperium lends its industrial might in support of local operations by replacing destroyed starships as time and facilities permit. At the end of each player turn all Imperial starships (but not other forces) that were eliminated during the player turn are placed on the Turn Record Chart so that one will appear per turn. These starships should be placed inverted to note that they are Imperial replacements. However, the Imperium will only replace starships of types CR, CA, B1, B2 or BB if the Imperial player currently has permission to build them. While the Imperial player may select the order in which losses are placed on the Turn Record Chart, future losses to be replaced must be placed on turns after the current replacements. As this procedure creates a backlog of replacements, the Imperial player may elect to scrap any of his replacements before they appear and move all replacements forward to fill the gaps. The appearance of replacements may not be reshuffled or their order redistributed after they are placed on the chart. Replacements may only be placed on the Chart, not beyond it.

Terran Technology Restrictions: The Terran player starts the first war with a lower level of technology than the Imperial player. Until the relevant technologies are acquired the Terran player may not:

- Produce Dreadnaughts or Battleships (types B and BB).
- Increase Jump Troops above factor 5 or Regulars above factor 3.
- Make more than 2 jumps in the Reaction Movement Phase.

GLORY

The Imperium extends far off-map: The portion of the Imperium on the map is only an Imperial province ruled by the governor at Gashidda. The Imperial player is not the emperor, but only a subordinate, answerable to the emperor and to his bureaucracy. This is reflected in the Glory Index, which indicates the level of recognition (and degree of esteem) the emperor and the bureaucracy hold for the governor.

The glory marker on the Turn Record Chart is used to record glory points. Each war begins with glory points set at 5. The conditions required to trigger a change in the Glory Index are listed on the Glory Point Table. All terms refer to the Imperial player, and only the Imperial player receives or loses Glory points. Glory point changes are noted immediately but any consequences take effect at the end of the Game Turn.

If a neutralised world marker becomes un-neutralised, the Glory points gained (or lost) as a result of its neutralisation are lost (or regained).

Victory: Glory is the final determinant of victory. If, at the end of a game turn, a player turn marker has reached or passed the glory point marker, the owner of that marker is victorious and the war ends. Thus, if at the end of Game Turn 5, the glory index still stands at 5, the Terran wins (the Imperial player turn marker being in the “6” box).

The Imperium

Each turn, during the Imperial Intervention subphase, the Imperial player checks for Imperial Intervention. In the Appeals to the Emperor subphase he may make a single appeal to the Emperor for assistance.

Imperial Intervention: To determine the influence of the Imperium on the game, roll two dice (modified by up to plus or minus two dependent upon the current Glory Index) and consult the Imperial Intervention Table. The dice total indicates the result, which is then implemented. Some results can cause changes in the Glory Index.

Appeals to the Emperor: It is possible that a direct appeal to the Emperor may result in a

favourable response. To make an appeal, the Imperial player must reduce the Glory Index by one and specify whether the Appeal for Increased Production Table or the Appeal for Increased Finances Table is to be consulted. Two dice are rolled and the result is implemented. Appeals may not be made if the current Glory Index is zero.

The Terran Republic

Each turn, during the Senate Intervention subphase, the Terran player checks for Intervention by the Senate. In the Research and Development subphase he may make a single roll on the Terran Technology Table.

Senate Intervention: To determine the influence of the Republican Senate on the game, roll two dice and consult the Senate Intervention Table. The dice total indicates the result, which is then implemented. Some results can cause changes in the Glory Index.

Research and Development: It is possible that investing in Research and Development may result in a technological advance. To invest in research, the Terran player must spend 5 RU's and consult the Terran Technology Table. Two dice are rolled and the result implemented. If a technology is rolled that has already been acquired, treat this as +1 on the next Technology Table roll. However, any +1 modifier lapses at the end of the war.

WARS AND PEACE

Imperium is intended to be a campaign game consisting of a series of wars fought until one side conquers the other.

A campaign game is begun by using the instructions given in the chosen scenario. At the end of the first war, determine the length of the peace before the next war begins and follow the procedure given here to determine initial forces and locations for the next war.

Succeeding wars continue until the campaign is won. The Terran player wins the campaign if the Imperial world marker on Gashidda is neutralised. The Imperial player wins if the Terran world marker on Sol is neutralised.

Repatriation of Forces: All troop and ship forces are immediately returned to the owning

player's home world. Their current location has no immediate importance in this procedure. Any worlds, which are neutralized at this point, remain neutralized.

Length of the Peace: A period of peace will follow the war. Each player secretly selects a number from 1 to 6 (using a die to indicate their chosen number). Then both simultaneously reveal their numbers. Add the two numbers together and deduct one. The result is the number of turns of peace until the next war.

Reparations: The winner of the war may now do one of the following at no cost:

- Place an outpost marker in an empty planetary surface box in each of two systems adjacent to existing friendly worlds or outposts.
- Replace an enemy outpost marker with a friendly outpost in one system adjacent to an existing friendly world or outpost.
- Place an outpost marker on an enemy neutralised world marker, or remove an outpost marker from a friendly neutralised world marker, in one system adjacent to an existing friendly world or outpost.

For the purposes of reparations, Procyon is considered to be adjacent to both Epsilon Eridani and Markhashi.

Territorial Conquest: Neutralized worlds with no enemy outpost present now become un-neutralized.

However, any outposts that are situated on an enemy neutralized world now roll on the Outpost Conversion Table. The owning player rolls one die and indexes the result to the row on the table corresponding to the length of the peace. If the roll is equal to or less than the number in the table the conversion is successful and the outpost is replaced by a friendly world marker (the enemy world marker is removed).

Note: If the roll is unsuccessful, it is possible for a neutralized world with an enemy outpost to be present, and for the next war to begin with this situation.

Then, any outposts in primary planetary surface boxes may now roll on the Outpost Conversion Table. If successful, they are also replaced by friendly world markers.

Interwar Income Phase: Each player now computes income available for war preparation: each player receives all accumulated RU on the Resource Unit Chart at the end of the war plus an amount equivalent to one full turn's income as normally computed.

Interwar Attrition: During extended periods of peace ships become old and planetary defences fall into disrepair.

Starships, planetary defence markers and troop counters suffer attrition if each rolls less than its maintenance number on one die. For the purposes of attrition (only), planetary defence markers and troop counters are considered to have a maintenance number of 2. The specific die roll is modified based on the specific number of turns of peace (as indicated on the Interwar Attrition Table). The die roll for any specific unit may be avoided by making a payment of twice the unit's maintenance number in RU.

Post-war Production: Items already paid for (or scheduled as replacements) and on the Turn Record Chart continue to appear during the turns of peace. Forces that are scheduled to appear after the start of the next war are scrapped. Post-war production is not subject to attrition.

Interwar Production: Each player may commit his resource units to production of forces for the upcoming war. The winner of the previous war produces his forces first. Any normally available forces may be built. However, peacetime conditions mean that any outposts produced cost only 2 RU (instead of their normal cost of 4 RU).

If the peace is only one turn long, the new production will appear at the beginning of the player's first player turn (capital ships appear at the beginning of the player's second player turn), rather than as initial forces.

Interwar Colonization: Each player may place outposts, provided that they were built during the interwar production or were otherwise unplaced and available. The winner places all of his outposts first, then the loser places his outposts. Each outpost placed must be adjacent to an pre-existing friendly world or outpost. For the purposes of this rule, Procyon

is considered to be adjacent to both Epsilon Eridani and Markhashi.

Redistribution of Forces: Both sides prior to the start of hostilities may redistribute all forces. They may be placed in any system containing a friendly world or outpost marker. The loser of the war sets up first. All forces automatically begin the new game in an undisturbed state.

The Attack: In the next war, the loser of the previous war moves first.

THE FIRST SHOTS

The First Interstellar War begins in AD 2113. Territorial frictions between the Imperium and the small, but growing, Terran Confederation finally brings this small section of the galaxy to the verge of war.

Terra: The Terran player receives the following forces as initial forces. World markers must be placed as noted, as must outposts. The remaining forces may be placed at any un-neutralised friendly worlds or outposts.

The Terran player sets up first and has the first player turn.

Forces	Location
3	Worlds (at Sol, Alpha Centauri A and Alpha Centauri B)
3	Outposts (at Junction, Barnard's Star, and Proxima Centauri)
3	Outposts (unplaced)
2	Planetary defence markers
1	Monitor
1	Missile boat
6	Scouts
2	Destroyers
1	Light cruiser
6	Transports
2	Regular troops (3)
1	Jump troop (5)

The Imperium: The Imperial player receives the following forces. World markers must be placed as noted, as must outposts. The remaining forces may be placed at any un-neutralised friendly worlds or outposts.

Forces	Location
4	Worlds (at Dingir, Gashidda, Ishkur and Nusku).
7	Outposts (at Agidda, Apishal, Enki Kamma, Shulgi, Shulgili, Shuruppak and Zaggisi).

3	Planetary defence markers
2	Monitors
2	Scouts
4	Destroyers
2	Light cruisers
1	Strike cruiser
1	Tanker
1	Transport
3	Regular troops (2)

CRISIS POINT

Terra: Setup restrictions are as per the previous scenario. The Terran has acquired "Advanced Troops" technology. The Terran player sets up first and has the first player turn.

Forces	Location
4	Worlds (at Sol, Alpha Centauri A, Alpha Centauri B and Mirabilis).
19	Outposts (at Agidda, Barnard's Star, Proxima Centauri, Ember, Peraspera, Loki, Junction, Midway, Dismal, Procyon, Hades, Inferno, Hephaistos, Calgary, Ys, Forlorn, Sarpedon, Remulak and Epsilon Eridani).
1	Planetary defence marker
4	Monitors
1	Mothership
10	Fighters
5	Scouts
9	Missile Boats
8	Destroyers
4	Light cruisers
3	Heavy Cruisers
1	Tanker
2	Transports
3	Regular troops (3)
3	Jump troops (4,4,6)

The Imperium: Setup restrictions are as per the previous scenario. The Imperial budget is 16 and he has permission to build heavy cruisers (CR).

Forces	Location
8	Worlds (at Dingir, Gashidda, Ishkur, Nusku, Lagash, Amarku, Tau Ceti and Epsilon Eridani (neutralised)).
8	Outposts (at Apishal, Enki Kalamma, Ishimshulgi, Markhashi, Shulgi, Shulgili, Shuruppak and Zaggisi).
3	Planetary defence markers
5	Monitors
1	Mothership
10	Scouts
8	Destroyers
9	Light cruisers
3	Strike cruisers
2	Heavy Cruiser
1	Tanker
3	Transports
5	Regular troops (2)
3	Jump Troops (4,5,6)

ARMAGEDDON

Terra: Setup restrictions are as per the first scenario. The Terran has the “Advanced Troops” and “B Production” technologies.

Forces	Location
5	Worlds (at Sol, Alpha Centauri A, Alpha Centauri B, Epsilon Eridani and Mirabilis).
17	Outposts (at Barnard's Star, Proxima Centauri, Ember, Peraspera, Loki, Junction, Midway, Dismal, Procyon, Hades, Inferno, Hephaistos, Calgary, Ys, Forlorn, Sarpedon and Remulak).
2	Planetary defence markers
3	Monitors

8	Fighters
4	Scouts
3	Missile Boats
6	Destroyers
4	Light cruisers
3	Heavy Cruisers
1	Dreadnaught
1	Tanker
2	Transports
4	Regular troops (3)
3	Jump troops (4,5,6)

The Imperium: Setup restrictions are as per the first scenario. The Imperial budget is 19 and he has permission to build heavy cruisers (CR) and dreadnaughts (B2). The Imperial player sets up first and has the first player turn.

Forces	Location
7	Worlds (at Dingir, Gashidda, Ishkur, Nusku, Lagash, Amarku, and Tau Ceti).
8	Outposts (at Apishal, Enki Kalamma, Ishimshulgi, Agidda, Shulgi, Shulgili, Shuruppak and Zaggisi).
3	Planetary defence markers
4	Monitors
1	Mothership
9	Scouts
7	Destroyers
4	Light cruisers
2	Strike cruisers
1	Heavy Cruiser
1	Dreadnaught (B2)
1	Tanker
3	Transports
5	Regular troops (2)
3	Jump troops (3,5,6)

